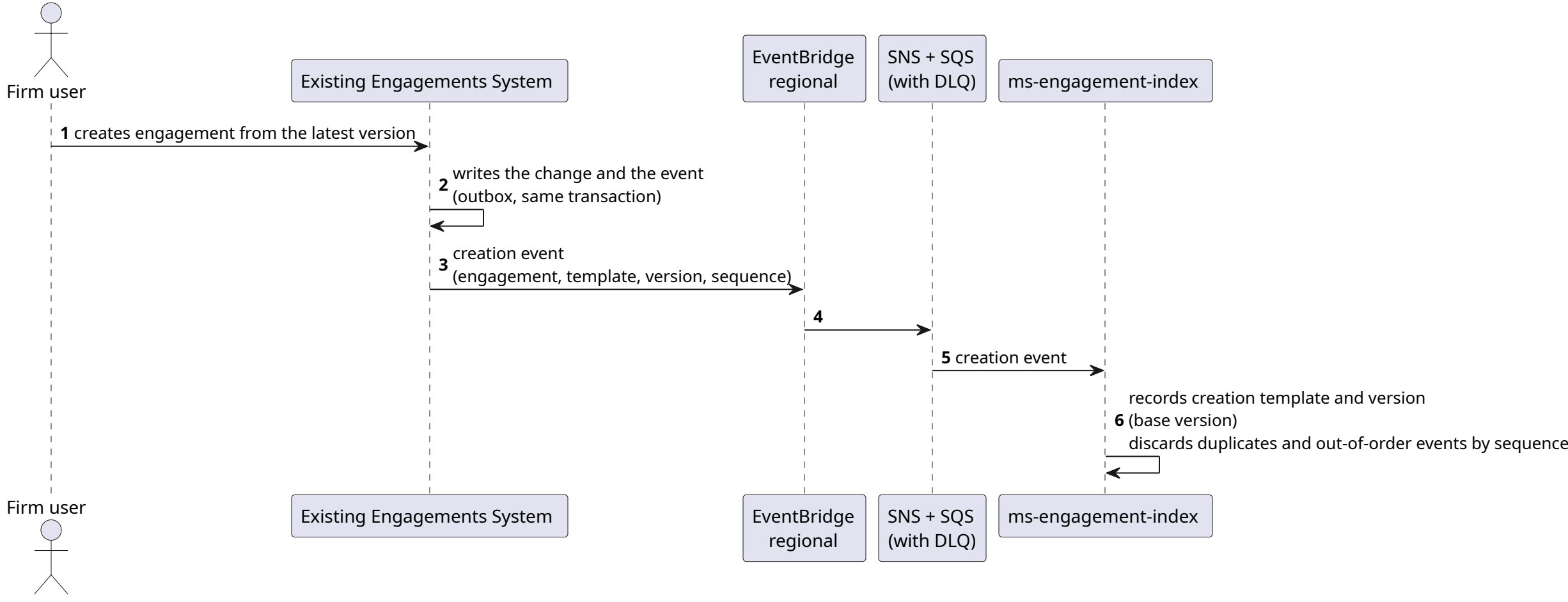2a. Engagement creation